The one disturbing development was that he was getting strange patches on his skin which, on October 20, were finally interpreted by Dr. Ryan as an allergy to milk. He assured us it would pass but that, for a while, David would have to switch to soybean extract, which would supply all necessary nutrition and which was nonallergenic. By now he was two months old and weighed nearly ten pounds.

By the twenty-ninth, after nine days on the soybean regimen, the patches on the skin were about gone, which demonstrated the correctness of Ryan's diagnosis.

I had a small dental problem of my own. The removable bridge that replaced my one missing tooth was beginning to affect its neighbors. In October, then, my dentist (a meticulous worker who drove me mad, however, by lecturing me in an ultrarightist manner while I was helpless in the dentist's chair) outfitted me with a permanent bridge. 3

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Now that David was with us, it was difficult to go out together; nay, impossible. We took to going to the movies separately, and on October 30, when I had to go to New York, I went alone, and Gertrude remained behind with David.

On arriving in New York, I went straight to Fred Pohl's to find out if he was indeed, as Scott had implied, about to fail. Mary Byers was working for him now and I saw her for the first time since that episode, 12 Vi years before, when I had introduced her to the Futurians. She was Mary Kornbluth now, was pregnant with twins, and was looking rather tired.

Fred admitted things were in a bad way. He was getting a divorce from Judy, was desperately trying to stay afloat, and asked me to have patience. Well, what could I do? I had patience.

3 Permanent, indeed. It's still with me today, as staunch as ever, and has never given me any trouble.

The next day I visited Brad, handed in the corrected galleys of David Starr: Space Ranger, and listened with a grin as he told me of how well Pebble in the Sky was doing. I also visited Scott Meredith, seeing him for the first time in nine years. He had put on weight, had taken off his mustache, was married, had a two-year-old son, and lived in Forest Hills.